

What to do when your Tor relay isn't listening

Cite as: Martin Paul Eve, "What to do when your Tor relay isn't listening", *eve.gd: Martin Paul Eve*, February 13, 2025, <https://doi.org/10.59348/td9j1-v3t48>.



I had a problem with [my Tor relay](#) last night. For some reason, the application (daemon) started but then after about 5 seconds it stopped listening. The Tor Metrics site was displaying a red button saying my node was unreachable and when I did “`sudo ss -ltp`” I got nothing. The application literally wasn’t “listening” (in network socket terms).

The answer was actually embarrassingly simple. If your Tor daemon stops listening, even if you can’t find a log entry saying why, it *could* be because you have burned through your entire traffic allocation for the accounting period. Increase the limit and try restarting it to avoid a red face.